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Managing payments

You can ask the customer to pay in basically two ways:

Cash on delivery: It's easy for you and for the customer but the problem is that the person who delivers the product has your money. This money would change hands many times before it reaches you and takes time. This can take its toll in the beginning when you would be short on cash!

Online payment: This is done via “payment gateways”. There are multiple providers available. If you're a programmer, you can have a look at the steps needed on their API documentation or contact them. Also, most banks (such as SBI, Citibank, HDFC, ICICI etc.) have their own payment gateways. You can create an account for your company and ask them for the service. Most payment gateways provide security by giving away SSL in their plans but that might be optional. You might want to have a look at various banks' websites which provide payment gateways. They provide both, financial as well as technical information on how to get it done. You could also opt for other payment gateway solutions such as CCAvenue. No matter which one you choose, you would have to utilize the API provided by them to use their services. You should also focus on the features provided by the gateway e.g. if you're getting a payment gateway service which doesn't support debit cards but supports Paypal, then it doesn't make sense from an Indian buyer's perspective.

Security

In some cases, you might need extra SSL certificates depending on the requirements of the chosen payment gateway as well as your own site design. If you do need more, then your web-host would be happy to sell you one. If you want a better SSL solution from a company such as VeriSign (or similar), then you'll need to follow extra steps and it would cost you more. Our advice: if you have to buy a SSL solution, ask your host first.



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